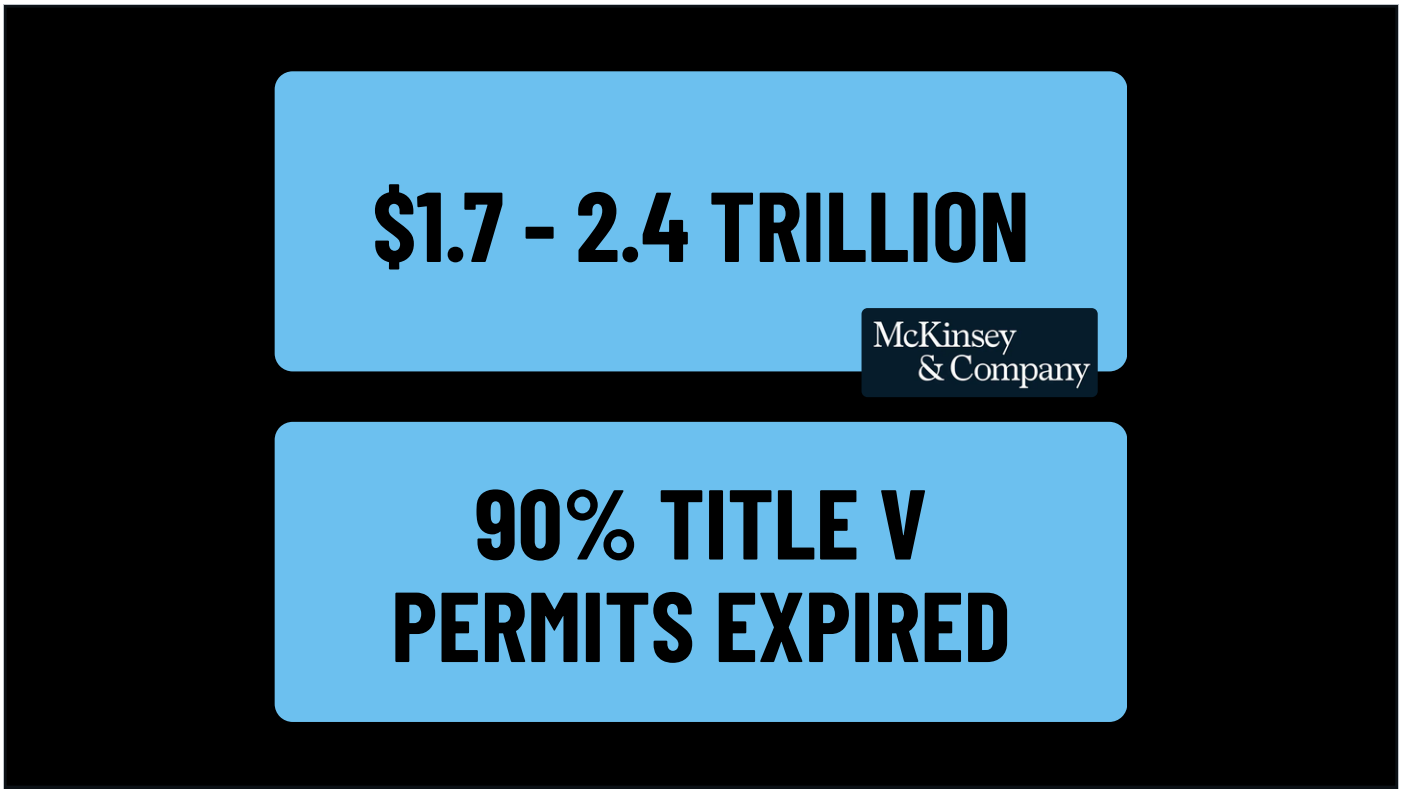
Welcome, and thanks for being here. What you're about to hear is a conversation about permits, trust, and time. It affects corporations, governments, and communities alike.

We'll explore the challenges and opportunities that arise when navigating the complex world of permits, particularly when dealing with expired ones. This discussion is crucial, as it involves multiple stakeholders—environmental groups, community leaders, permit applicants, health departments, and government agencies—all with vested interests and concerns.

Our aim is to shed light on how these groups can collaborate to ensure effective and timely processing. We'll address questions such as: How can we build trust among stakeholders? What strategies can be implemented to expedite procedures without compromising environmental and community standards? And importantly, how can we ensure that job opportunities are not hindered in the process?

By the end of this session, we hope to have fostered a deeper understanding of the intricacies involved and sparked innovative ideas for moving forward collaboratively. Thank you for joining us on this journey toward a more efficient and trustworthy permit system.



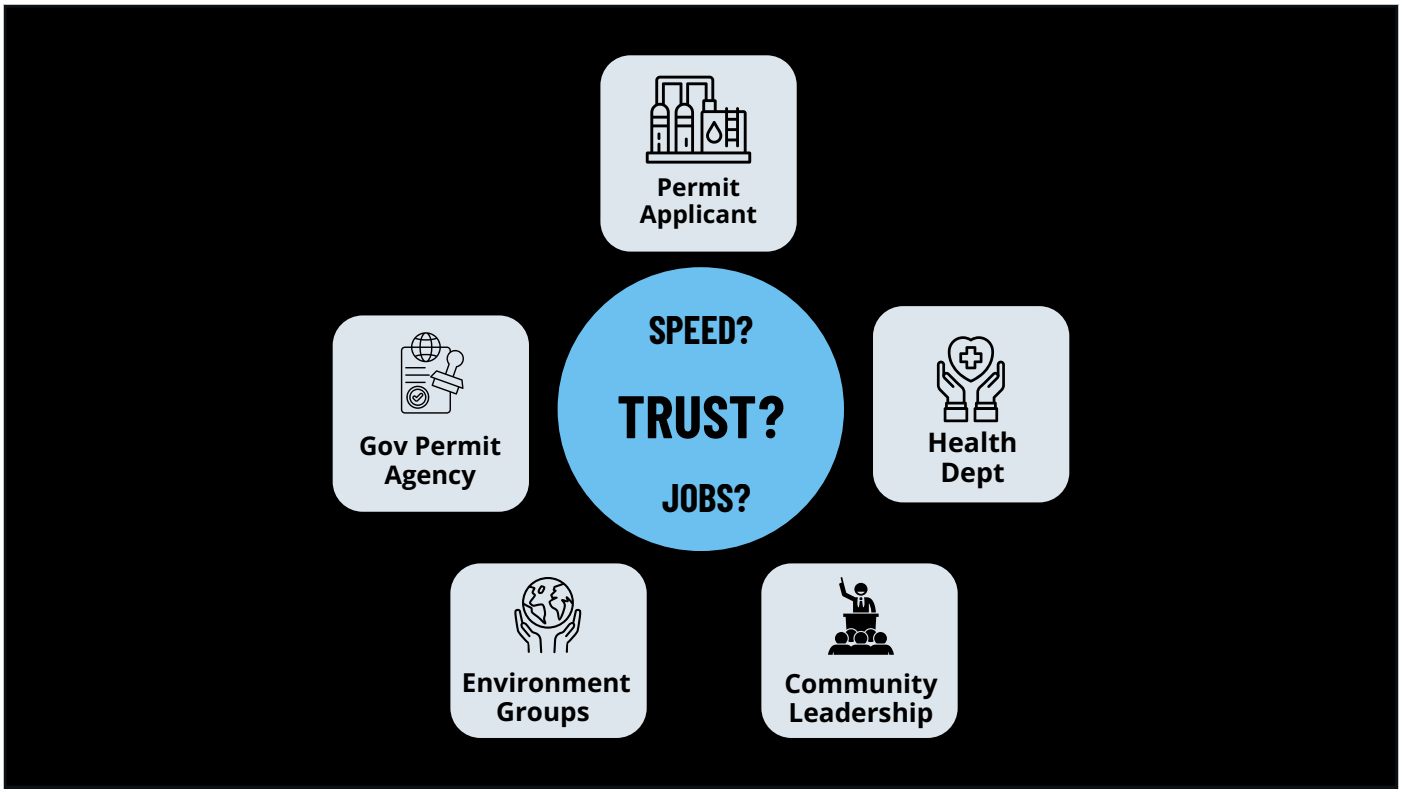
BLOCK ONE — CHAPTER 1: INTRODUCTION

Framing the Problem

JULIAN (measured, confident):

In the world of business expansion and economic development, this country has a serious glass-half-full, glass-half-empty problem—one that, until now, no one has directly addressed.
On the glass-half-full side, the opportunity is massive. According to McKinsey & Company, companies are prepared to spend roughly seven trillion dollars globally building and operating data centers. Beyond that, corporations across the United States are ready to invest billions—and in some cases trillions—of dollars in new plants, expansions, and infrastructure.
The capital is there. The demand is real.
But here's the glass-half-empty side.
All of these projects require permits. And again, according to McKinsey, approximately one-point-seven trillion dollars in planned expansions are currently stalled—not because companies lack funding or intent, but because of permitting delays.
If we look at air permits alone, the problem becomes very real. In states like Minnesota, Title V air permits are backlogged by years. In Oregon, some permits have gone years without renewal. And in parts of western New York, nearly ninety percent of Title V facilities are operating under expired permits—some for more than a decade.
What's ironic is that many of these delayed projects are data centers being built to support artificial intelligence—yet until now, AI itself hasn't been meaningfully used to solve the permitting

problems slowing them down.
That’s what this conversation is about.



BLOCK TWO — CHAPTER 2: BACKGROUND

Purpose, Credibility, and Trust

JULIAN (calm, direct, disarming):

For corporations: you already have the capital and the legal teams. What you don't have is speed. If permitting timelines could be dramatically reduced without increasing risk, would you do it?

For government officials: you're facing growing backlogs, tighter budgets, and more complex regulations. If those backlogs could be reduced without new funding or legislation, would you consider it?

And for communities]\nonprofits, local leaders, environmental groups—if your concerns were addressed before permits were issued, if your ideas were incorporated into the process, and if companies were required to support real community development rather than just create a small number of jobs, would you support that approach?

My name is Julian Smith. I'm the Chief Marketing Officer of the Apex Environmental Resolution Group, which created LSARS — the Life Science Analysis and Reporting Solution.

Apex combines experience, trust, and real-world collaboration with the LSARS platform, which uses artificial intelligence to organize permits, environmental records, and compliance data—so

people, not machines, can identify risks earlier and move projects forward more fairly and faster.

My role here is simple: to ask the kinds of questions executives, regulators, community leaders, and environmental advocates would ask before trusting anyone with projects that have real environmental and community impact.
And it’s important to be clear about what this interview is not.

This is not a designed sales pitch. We’re not here to sell you anything. This is an informational conversation. You decide—based on what you hear—whether this approach earns your trust.

So as you listen, the question isn’t how impressive we think LSARS or Apex is. The question is whether this approach can be customized to meet your needs, your constraints, and your commun ity.
Environment Groups
Commercial Permit Applicants
Community Leadership
Health Dept
Gov Permit Agency
TM
Permits
Apex

BLOCK THREE — CHAPTER 3: THE INTERVIEW

The Question of Difference

JULIAN

With that, I'd like to introduce the founder and visionary behind Apex, and the co-founder and visionary behind LSARS—my father, Nelson Smith.

Hi, Dad. Before we get into your background, I want to start with a few tough questions to help listeners decide early on whether Apex and LSARS are even right for them.
So let's start here—who is Apex?

NELSON:
When we say "Apex," we're talking about Apex Environmental Resolution Group. Within that organization, one of the core components is Apex Environmental Consulting.

JULIAN (light laugh):

There are a lot of moving parts here. So give us the short version—who are Apex Environmental Resolution Group, Apex Environmental Consulting, and LSARS?

NELSON:

Apex Environmental Resolution Group is a collaboration of three entities. HPR Analytics focuses on health-related consulting. LSA Digital develops artificial intelligence and data-driven solutions. And my team, Apex Environmental Consulting, works at the intersection of environmental, corporate, government, and community challenges.

Together, we developed a proprietary AI software platform called LSARS—the Life Science Analysis and Reporting Solution—which brings those disciplines into a single framework designed to resolve complex issues faster and with far less conflict.

BLOCK FOUR — CHAPTER 4: HOW BREAKTHROUGHS ACTUALLY HAPPEN

JULIAN:

How did you come up with the concept for Apex and LSARS—and why do you believe you can solve a problem that, so far, no one else has solved?
In other words, what makes you different?

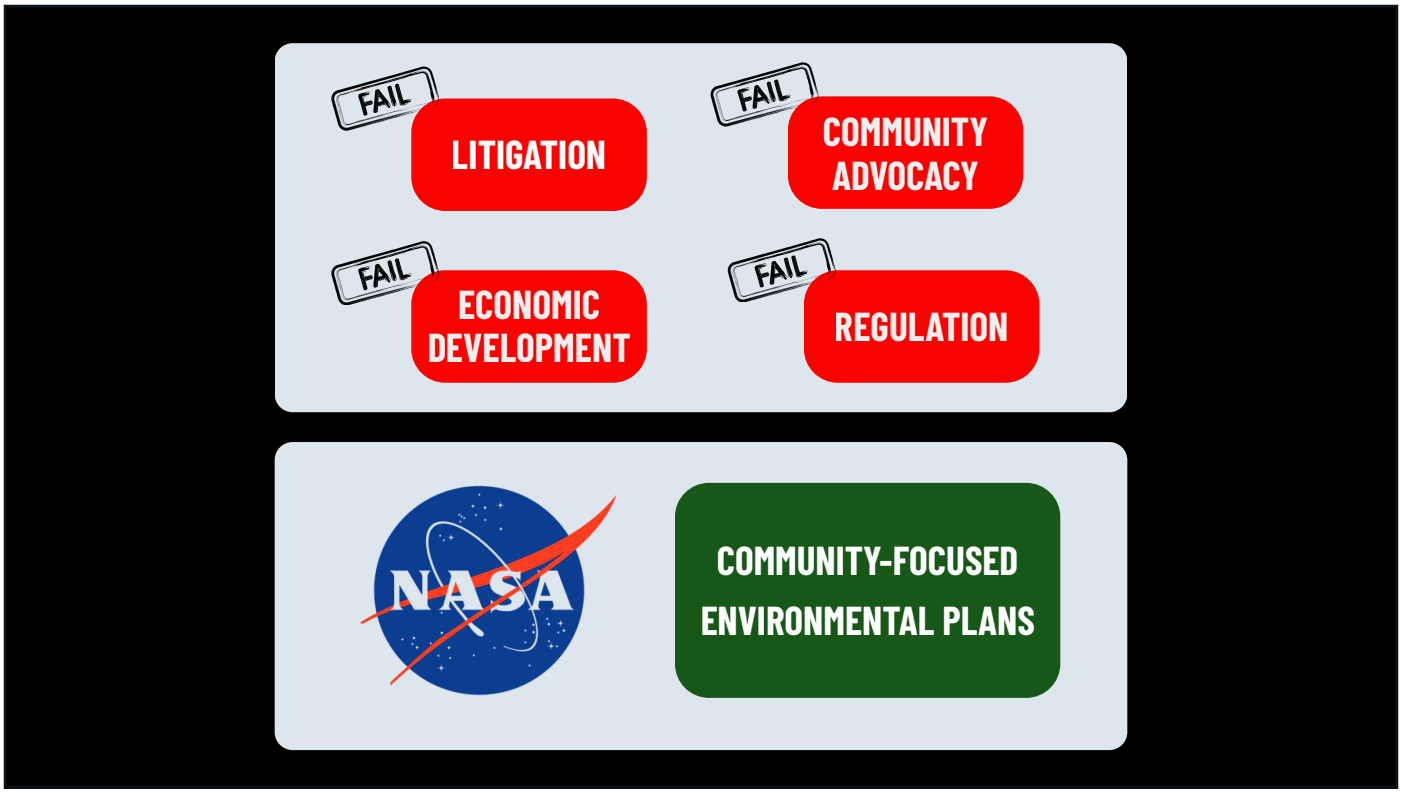
NELSON:

The most effective way to solve complex problems isn't to start by trying to fix them directly. It's to take successful processes from one area and apply them thoughtfully to another.

Let me give you two examples.
For decades, companies tried—and failed—to solve hair loss by targeting the problem directly. Then a drug called minoxidil was developed to treat high blood pressure. Hair growth wasn't the goal. But physicians observed it happening in real-world use. That observation led to one of the most widely used hair-loss treatments in the world.

The same thing happened with weight-loss drugs. GLP-1 medications were developed to treat diabetes. During clinical use, doctors consistently observed reduced appetite and sustained weight loss. What started as an unintended effect became a breakthrough once it was carefully studied and developed.

In both cases, the solution didn’t come from trying to fix the problem directly. It came from observing real-world outcomes and asking a better question: what else can this process solve?
That same principle led to Apex and LSARS.



BLOCK FIVE — CHAPTER 5: OBSERVATION BEFORE SOLUTION

JULIAN:

So you didn't set out to solve air permitting delays?

NELSON:

Exactly. We didn't start by saying, "Let's fix air permitting."
The solution emerged through years of observing real-world failures across litigation, regulation, community advocacy, and economic development.
What I saw repeatedly was that permitting delays weren't just regulatory problems. They were process failures—failures of coordination, trust, timing, and incentives.
And those failures hurt everyone: companies, regulators, and communities.

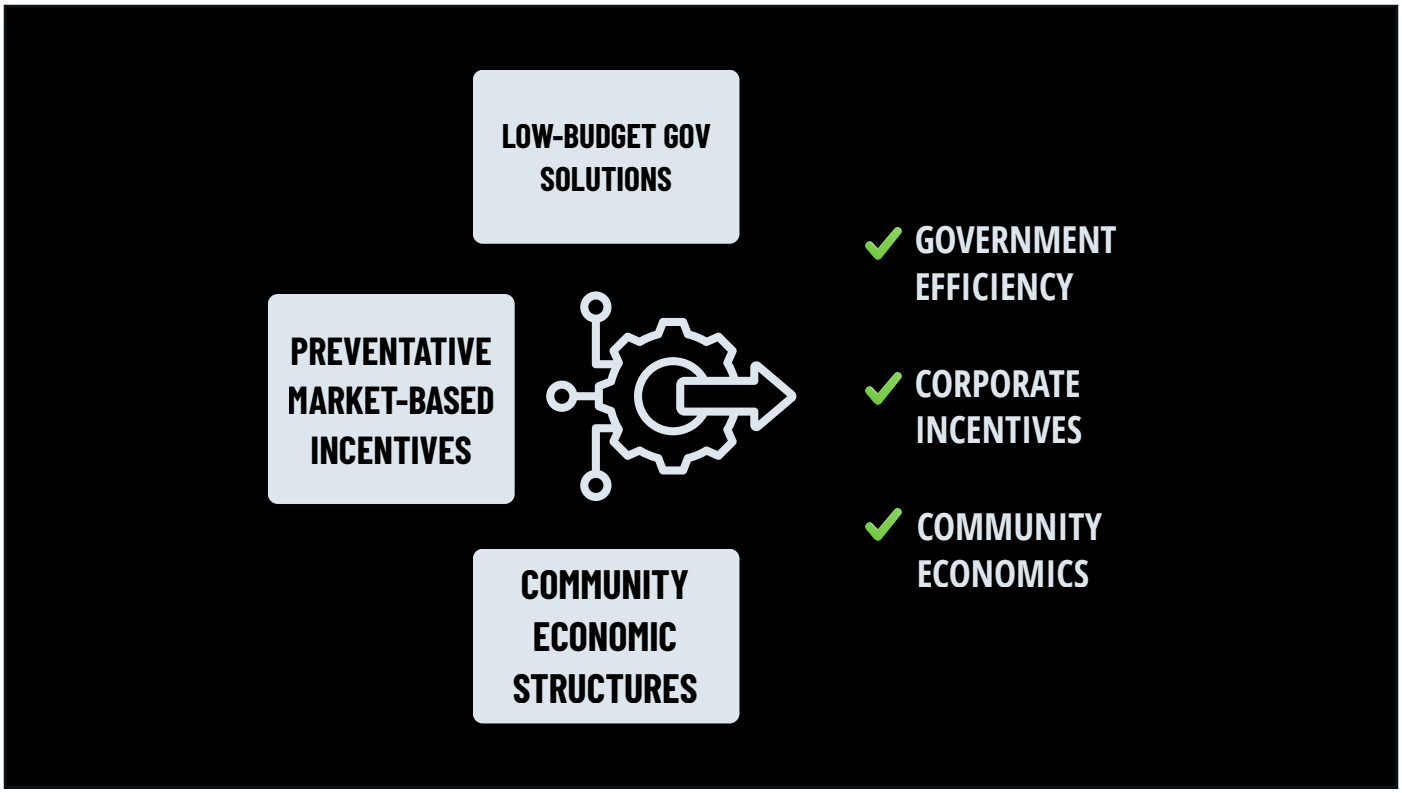
JULIAN:

What experience gave you the foundation to see this differently?

NELSON:

This comes from more than 35 years of work across government, private practice, litigation, and community development—both in the United States and internationally.

I began my career as the lead national environmental compliance and policy attorney for NASA. I worked in environmental law, engineering, and regulatory analysis. I represented corporations and communities in complex environmental litigation and developed community-focused environmental plans across multiple regions.
Across all of it, one insight kept repeating: the traditional way we try to solve environmental problems leaves critical gaps.



BLOCK SIX — CHAPTER 6: THREE PROVEN PROCESSES & TRUST

JULIAN:

So what process did you rely on to address those gaps?

NELSON:

Three processes, developed independently over decades.
First, creating workable solutions for governments that lack funding but still face complex environmental responsibilities.

Second, using preventive, market-based incentives—rewarding companies for reducing pollution before it occurs, rather than only penalizing them afterward.

Third, helping communities use environmental technologies to build economic structures, not just compliance outcomes.
Apex and LSARS bring these three processes—government efficiency, corporate incentives, and community economics—into a single, integrated approach.

JULIAN:

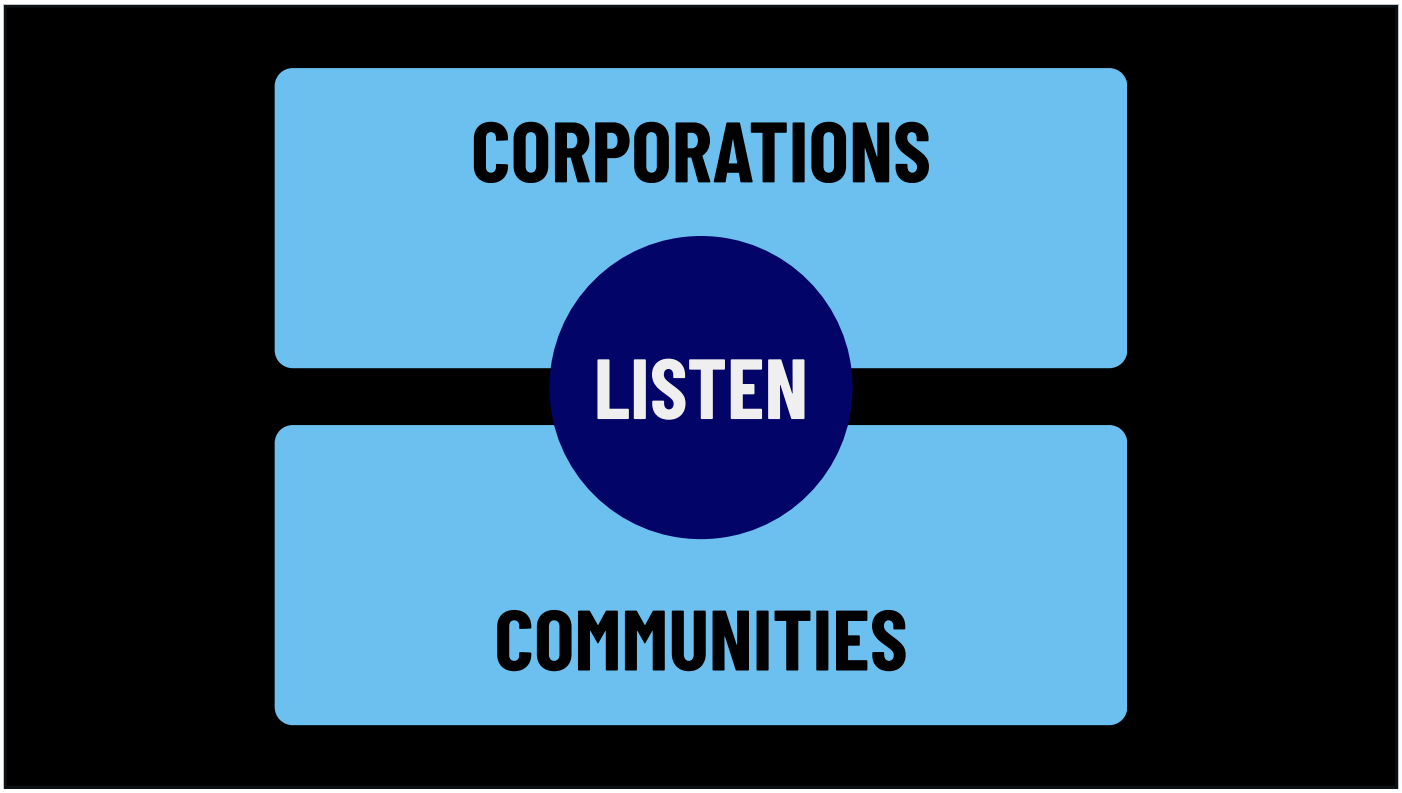
Communities have been promised a lot over the years. Why should they trust you?

NELSON:

Trust can't be claimed. It has to be demonstrated.
For more than 25 years, I've chosen to represent people and communities even when it came at personal cost. I represented clients in major pharmaceutical litigation, ensuring they were supported beyond settlement. I spent over a decade representing thousands of individuals affected by the opioid crisis, listening to every client and developing frameworks others described as fair.

I worked directly with city leaders, nonprofits, and residents in places like Newark, New Jersey, and with regional leaders internationally—always listening first, designing second.

The best solutions come from the people most affected by the outcome.



BLOCK SEVEN — CHAPTER 7: BRIDGING CORPORATIONS AND COMMUNITIES

JULIAN:

Do you have experience bringing corporations and communities together?

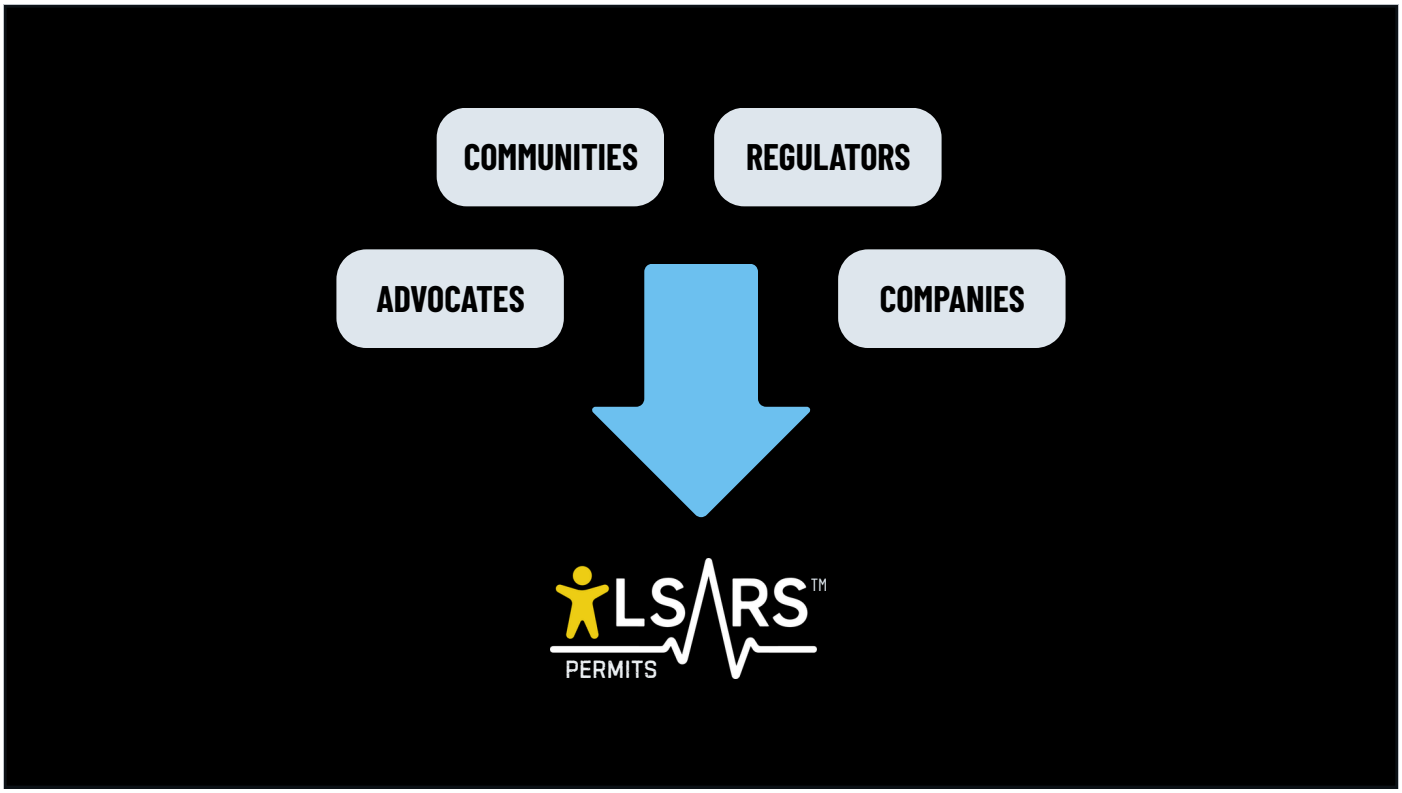
NELSON:

Yes—from both sides.
I was hired by a Fortune 100 company to help them avoid massive verdicts in high-risk jurisdictions. The approach wasn't defensive. It was relational. We listened, engaged locally, and helped create real economic benefits. Over time, the company stopped being viewed as an advers ary.

Years later, I represented those same communities. I've also spent years working alongside hourly employees— not as management, but as

a worker. —because understanding people requires standing where they stand .

That’s why Apex is family-owned. These principles weren’t theorized. They were lived.



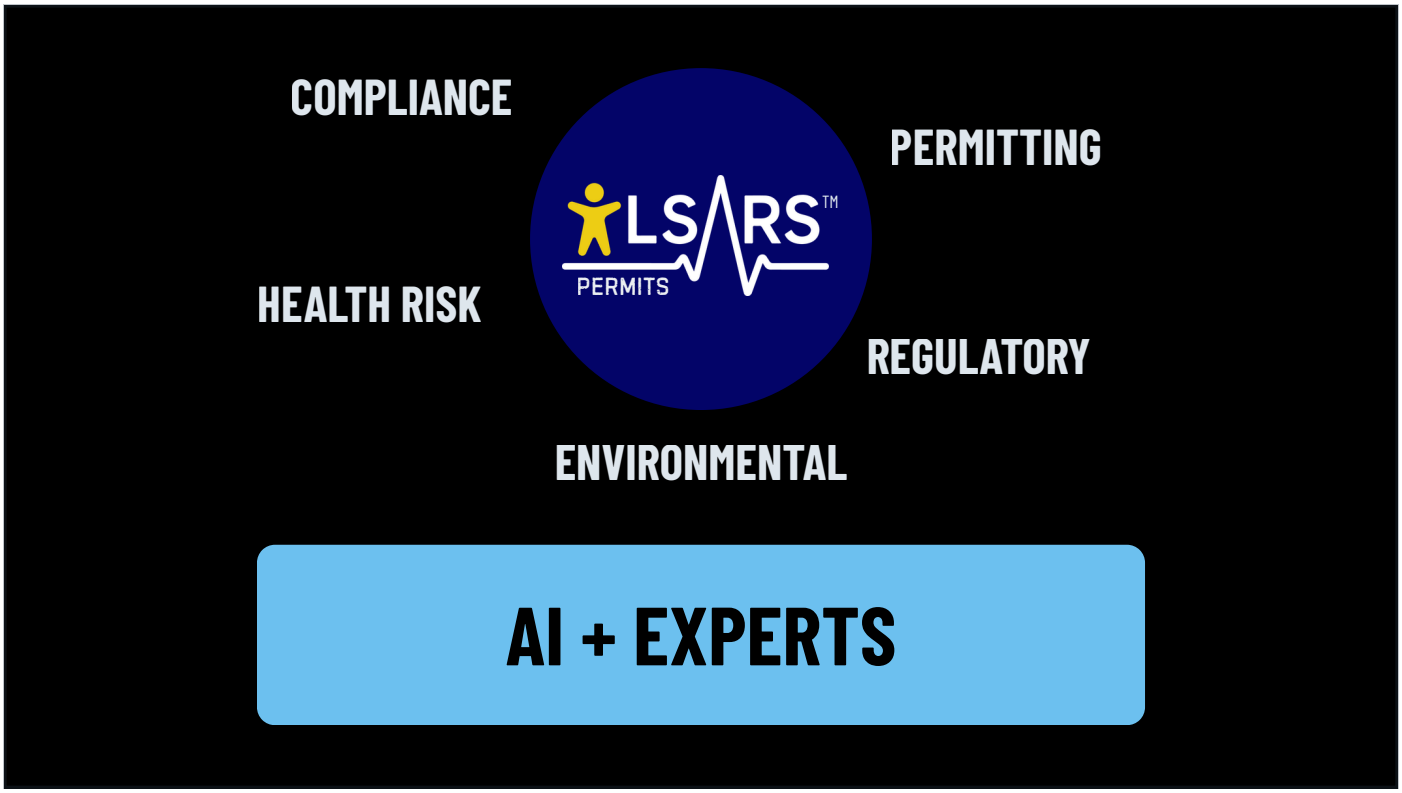
BLOCK EIGHT — CHAPTER 8: TRANSITION TO LSARS

JULIAN:

You've explained the philosophy and the process. How does this work in practice?

NELSON:

It starts with building teams that can earn trust across all sides. Then it requires something most systems skip—spending real time listening to regulators, companies, communities, and advocates, and building those insights directly into LSARS.



JULIAN:
Many people are here to understand LSARS. What is it—plainly and practically?

NELSON:
LSARS stands for Life Science Analysis and Reporting Solution.

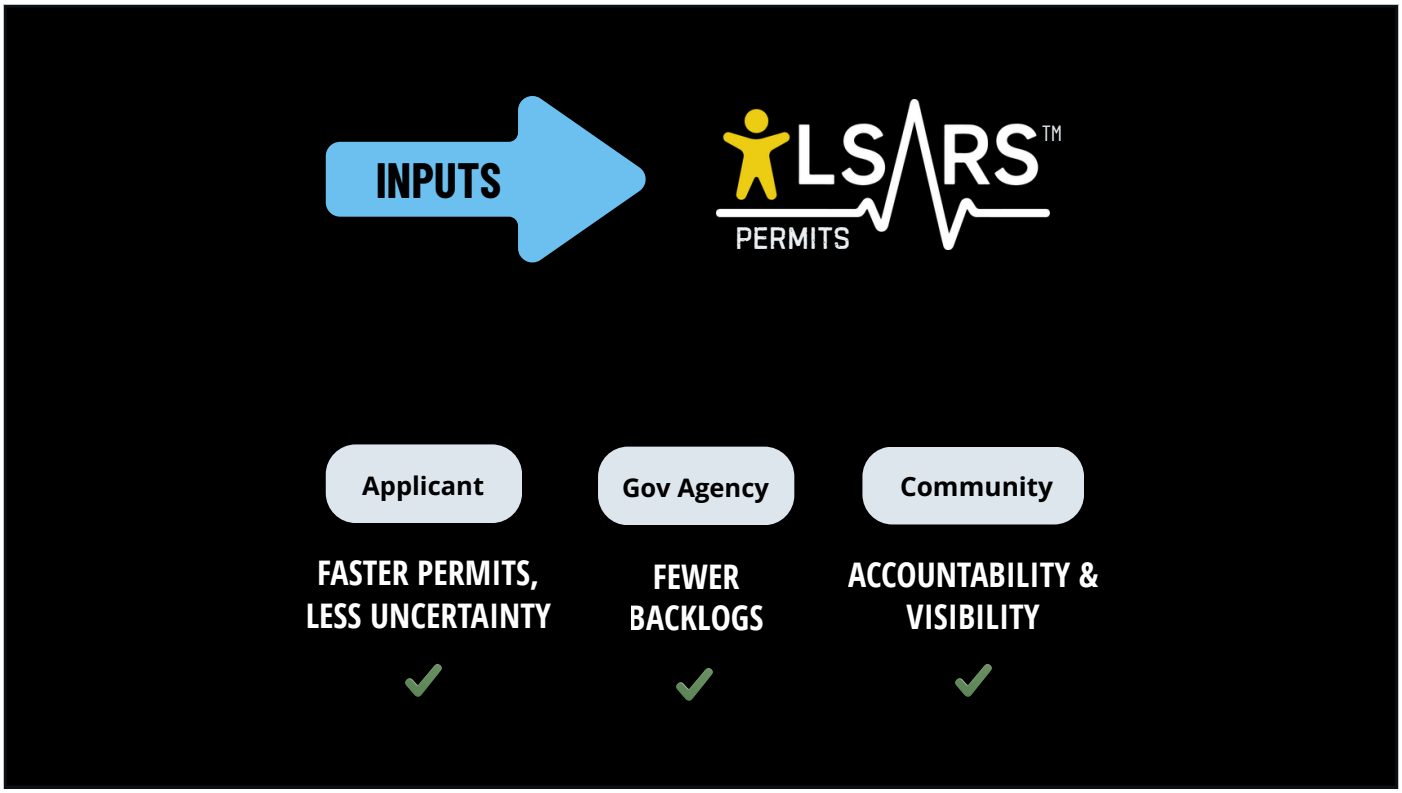
It's not a traditional product, and it doesn't replace regulators, lawyers, engineers, or communities.

LSARS uses artificial intelligence to organize massive amounts of environmental, permitting, regulatory, and compliance information into a single coherent system—so people can actually understand it and work from th e same set of facts.

Today, that information is fragmented across agency files, consultant reports, emails, spreadsheets, public comments, historical permits, and enforcement records.
LSARS bring s it together, organizes it chronologically and contextually, and makes relationships visible—what changed, when, why, and who raised concerns.

LSARS do esn't make decisions. P eople do. It removes confusion,

fragmentation, and blind spots that slow everything down and create mistrust.



BLOCK TEN — CHAPTER 10: WHY LSARS IS DIFFERENT

JULIAN:

A lot of people claim to use AI. What makes LSARS different?

NELSON:

Most systems optimize for one stakeholder. LSARS works across all stakeholders simultaneously.

It's process-driven, to achieve the outcomes stakeholders are looking for. Issues surface earlier—when they're cheaper and easier to resolve. For example, when fast, high-quality Health Risk Assessment data flows into a dashboard, there is less back-and-forth between regulators and permit requestors, and the process goes faster.
It's inclusive by design.

Community input and agency feedback are incorporated early and tracked over time.
And LSARS identifies patterns humans often miss— recurring objections, regulatory inconsistencies, outdated conditions, and likely delay points.

Fo r corporations, that means less uncertainty and shorter time lines.

For agencies, fewer backlo gs without added staff.

For communities, accountability and visibility.

BLOCK ELEVEN — CHAPTER 11: ECONOMIC DEVELOPMENT & OFFSETS

JULIAN:

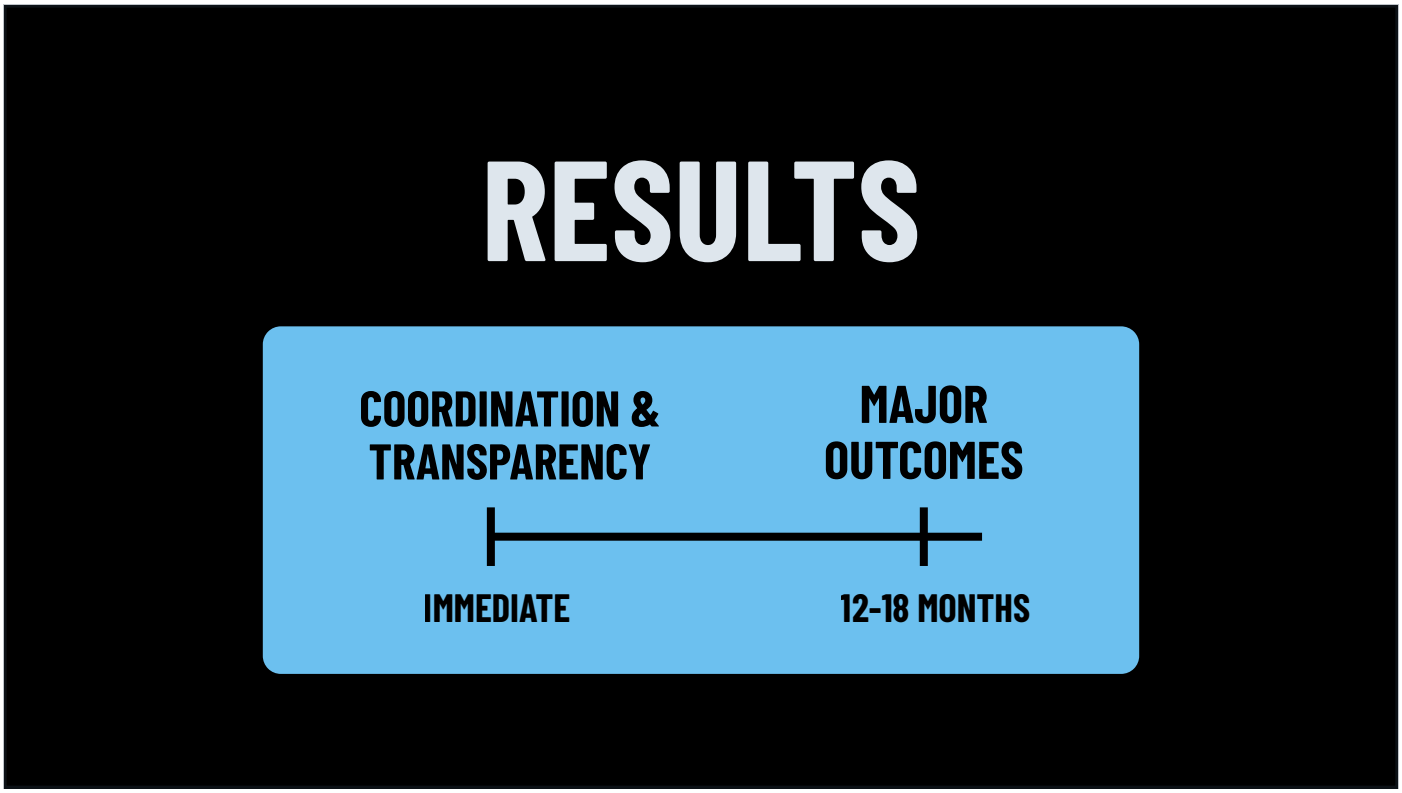
You've mentioned economic development plans. How do we know they work?

NELSON:

Our model draws from military offset programs used globally.
Countries like Turkey require companies to invest locally through structured industrial participation. The UAE centralizes offset funds through the Tawazun Council, converting obligations into measurable pro jects.

W e adapt that model to env ironmental and permitting projects—focusing on workforce training, infrastructure, renewable energy, and community monitoring.

LSARS t racks every commitm ent, dollar, and outcome so obligations don't disappear after permits are issued.



BLOCK TWELVE — CHAPTER 12 & 13: TIMING AND GLOBAL USE

JULIAN:

How long does it take to see results?

NELSON:

Based on pilots and simulations, tangible results appear within 12 to 18 months. Some benefits—like coordination and transparency—are immediate. Others take time, but progress is measurable from day one.

JULIAN:

Can this work globally ?

NE LSON:

Yes. LSARS creates t ransparency and acc ountability even where enforcem ent structures are weak. It aligns incentives, tracks commitments, and creates virtual enforcemen t through visibility.

BLOCK THIRTEEN — CHAPTER 14: CONCLUSION

JULIAN:

So LSARS and Apex aren't just tools—they're a framework.

NELSON:

Exactly. LSARS is the engine. Apex is the trusted operator. Communities are the validators.

JULIAN:

Last question. You've said you're not selling—you want people to buy. What does that mean?

NELSON:

We ask for 15 to 30 minutes—not to p itch, but to listen. No pressure. No commitments. Out of list ening comes clarity. Sometimes the right answer is no. Trust is b uilt faster by honesty than p ersuasion.
Buying happens n
aturally when people feel heard.

J ULIAN:

Th ank you.

N ELSON:

T hank you. And to everyone lis tening: measure everything, trust through transparency, a nd remember—the trust- building process creates la sting results.

LET'S BUILD TRUST, TOGETHER

LSARS PERMITS

APEX

INFO@LSARS.COM